

SPEAKING ACTIVITY

Objective: In pairs, choose one of the following notable figures in the field of computer science. Find significant information about the person you choose and prepare a very simple presentation in which you make use of the expressions listed below.

Step by step instructions

1. Form pairs and choose a different figure for each pair.
2. Research key facts: date of birth, place of birth, education, main achievements, contributions to computer science, and legacy.
3. Prepare a short oral presentation (2–3 minutes).

Notable figures in computer science

- **Alan Turing:** “Alan Turing’s codebreaking work at Bletchley Park was vital to the Allied victory in World War II.”
- **Grace Hopper:** “Grace Hopper developed the first compiler, which made programming languages easier to use.”
- **Linus Torvalds:** “Linus Torvalds created the Linux kernel, which is the basis of many operating systems today.”
- **Tim Berners-Lee:** “Tim Berners-Lee invented the World Wide Web, which revolutionized global communication.”
- **John von Neumann:** “John von Neumann developed key concepts in computer architecture and made foundational contributions to computing and game theory.”
- **Donald Knuth:** “Donald Knuth authored *The Art of Computer Programming*, a foundational work on algorithms and analysis of algorithms.”
- **Katherine Johnson:** “Katherine Johnson performed the precise orbital calculations that were critical to early NASA crewed spaceflights.”

USEFUL EXPRESSIONS

- ✚ “Today I’m going to talk about the life and achievements of...”
- ✚ -“He/She is widely regarded as one of the most influential figures in the history of computing.”
- ✚ -“Born in [year] in [place], he/she showed an early interest in...”
- ✚ -“His/Her work laid the foundations for
- ✚ -“He/She is best known for developing/creating/inventing...”
- ✚ -“One of his/her greatest contributions was...”

✚ -“Thanks to his/her research, we now understand...”

✚ -“This innovation completely changed the way we...”

✚ -“He/She played a crucial role in...”

Today I’m going to talk about the life and achievements of James Gosling.

He/She is widely regarded as
one of the most influential figures in the history of
computing.

Born in 1955 in Calgary, Alberta, Canada,
he/she showed an early interest in software development.

He/She is best known for developing Java programming language.
He first started working in SunMicroSystems, where he invented an early Unix
windowing system. Then, he got an idea for the virtual machine
while writing program to port a software and he had to translate Perq Q-code
to VAX assembler.
So he thought of VM
He left SunMicroSystems in 2010, was acquired by ORacle
Then he worked in Google then Amazon.